

USA: Initial Jobless Claims Somewhat Below Expectations

BOTTOM LINE: Initial jobless claims declined, against expectations for a modest increase. Continuing claims edged up to 1,955k from a downwardly-revised level in the prior week, in line with consensus expectations.

US MAP:

Initial claims 0 (2, 0)

Continuing claims 0 (2, 0)

KEY NUMBERS:

Initial claims 217k for the week ended July 19 vs. GS 231k, median forecast 226k, prior 221k

Continuing claims 1,955k for the week ended July 12 vs. median forecast 1,954k, prior revised 1,951k

MAIN POINTS:

1. Initial jobless claims declined 4k to 217k in the week ended July 19, against expectations for a modest increase. The four-week moving average of claims fell by 5k to 225k. Claims increased by 5k in Kentucky and 4k in Massachusetts but declined by 3k in New York, and 2k in California and Michigan (all state-level data seasonally adjusted by GS). Nationwide continuing claims—the number of persons receiving benefits through standard programs—rose 4k to 1,955k in the week ended July 12 from a downwardly-revised level in the prior week (-5k to 1,951k), in line with consensus expectations.

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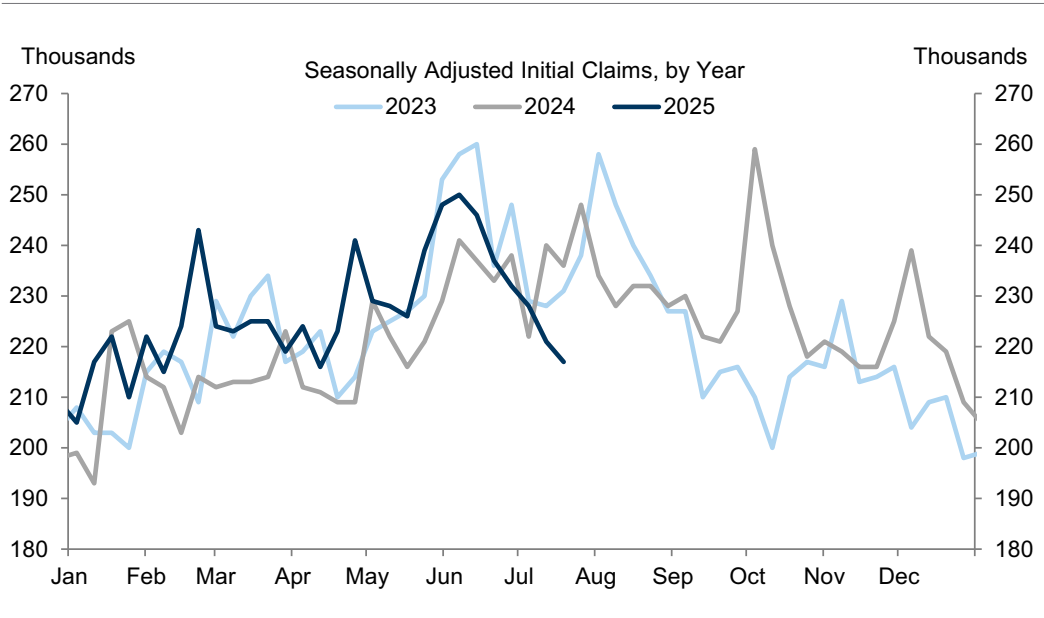
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